

Receptionist

The Receptionist serves as the professional face of the school, managing a high-volume front-of-house environment within a large and dynamic educational setting. This role is essential for maintaining a secure, welcoming, and efficient entry point for students, staff, parents, and professional visitors. Working under the direction of the Office Manager, the Receptionist ensures that communication flows effectively across various departments and colleges, supporting the academy's commitment to high standards and inclusive practice.

Core Purpose

- Deliver a professional, high-standard reception service that meets the needs of a large secondary community.
- Manage complex communication channels, ensuring information reaches the correct internal stakeholders promptly.
- Maintain a secure and organised environment, acting as the first line of defense for site security.
- Provide proactive administrative support to ensure the efficient daily operation of the academy office.

Key Areas of Responsibility

1. Front of House & Visitor Management

- Provide a professional and welcoming greeting to all visitors, including parents, contractors, and external agencies.
- Maintain the reception area to a high professional standard, ensuring it is organised and reflects the academy's values.
- Manage the visitor sign-in system rigorously, issuing badges and ensuring all safeguarding protocols are followed.
- Coordinate the receipt and secure distribution of mail and deliveries across a large site.

2. Communication & Digital Systems

- Manage a busy switchboard, screening and forwarding calls to relevant departments or colleges while handling queries directly where possible.
- Monitor and manage the central office email account, directing correspondence to the appropriate staff or the Senior Leadership Team.
- Support the administration of parent communication and payment platforms, assisting stakeholders with technical enquiries.
- Ensure all outgoing correspondence to parents and external agencies is quality assured and proofread for professionalism.

3. Student Support & Attendance

- Support the monitoring of student attendance, including assisting with first-day calling and updating records as required.
- Maintain accurate student data on internal systems (e.g., Bromcom), ensuring information from parents is processed quickly.
- Issue login details for curriculum-based digital platforms as directed by the SLT.
- Interact with students in a mature, professional manner, upholding the academy's "warm strict" approach to behavior and conduct.

4. Operational & Leadership Support

- Organise and prepare meeting rooms for staff, parents, and external professionals.
- Monitor office supplies and place orders to ensure the smooth running of administrative functions.
- Undertake a variety of administrative tasks, including scanning, filing, and shredding, as directed by the Office Manager.
- Support the academy's profile within the local community through excellent customer service and engagement.

Professional Expectations

This job description outlines the general duties and responsibilities of the post but does not specify the time allocation or detailed working methods for each. Duties may evolve in line with the changing needs of the academy, and the description will be reviewed at least annually in consultation with the post holder.

Flexibility and collaboration are key aspects of the role. The SENCo is expected to contribute to the wider leadership of the school and support the development of inclusive practice across all departments and phases.

Safeguarding and Pupil Welfare

All responsibilities must be carried out in line with the Trust's safeguarding policies. The SENCo plays an essential role in promoting a safe, supportive environment for all pupils, especially those who may be more vulnerable due to their individual needs.

Staff are expected to understand the indicators of abuse and neglect, and to take prompt, appropriate action where concerns arise. All members of staff must be familiar with the latest Keeping Children Safe in Education guidance and engage with annual safeguarding training.

Person Specification – Receptionist

This section outlines the essential and desirable attributes expected for the role of Receptionist.

Qualifications and Training

Essential:

- A high level of literacy and numeracy.
- Proficient in Google Workspace, or similar systems.

Desirable:

- Evidence of recent professional development related to administration or customer service.
- Training in safeguarding, first aid, or data protection (GDPR).

Experience

Essential:

- Proven ability to work effectively with colleagues, parents, and multi-agency teams.
- Experience in prioritising a diverse and heavy workload in a high-pressure environment.

Desirable:

- Previous experience in a customer-facing or reception role.
- Experience working within a secondary school or large educational organisation.
- Experience using school management systems such as Bromcom

Professional Knowledge, Skills and Understanding

Essential:

- Excellent verbal and written communication skills suitable for a range of professional audiences.
- Outstanding attention to detail and organizational skills.
- Ability to maintain absolute confidentiality at all times.
- Understanding of the importance of school security and visitor management.

Desirable:

- Knowledge of safeguarding and "Keeping Children Safe in Education" guidance.

Personal Qualities and Attributes

The role requires an individual who is **approachable, empathetic, and professional** in all interactions. They must demonstrate significant **resilience and adaptability**, particularly when managing complex or high-pressure situations at the front desk, while maintaining a **calm, solution-focused approach**. A strong commitment to inclusion and the belief that every student can thrive is essential. The successful candidate will be a **confident communicator**, able to **build positive relationships** across the school community and **model integrity** through their personal and professional conduct.

